

PAUL LEONE

Cybersecurity Analyst | SOC Operations | Detection Engineering

Yorktown Heights, NY | 914.441.0968 | pnleone@outlook.com | linkedin.com/in/pnleone | CCNA | Security+

IT/Infrastructure professional transitioning into cybersecurity with enterprise architecture and operations experience. Combines deep network, systems, and cloud knowledge with hands-on SOC skills in SIEM/EDR monitoring, alert triage, threat detection, and incident response. Certified in CCNA and Security+; active lab-based development in detection engineering, threat hunting, and vulnerability management.

CORE COMPETENCIES

SOC & Detection	SIEM/EDR (ELK, Splunk, Wazuh), Alert Triage (TheHive/Cortex), Threat Hunting, IDS/IPS Tuning (Suricata, Snort), Incident Response, SOAR (Shuffle, TheHive, MISP), Packet Inspection (Wireshark, Zeek), Vulnerability Management (OpenVAS, Nessus)
Network & Identity	TCP/IP, DNS, VPN, OSPF, Firewalls (pfSense, OPNsense, FortiGate, Palo Alto), Active Directory, OIDC/OAuth2, MFA, Zero Trust
Scripting & Automation	Bash, PowerShell, Terraform, Ansible, Python, n8n, Shuffle
Infrastructure	Windows, Linux, Docker, Kubernetes (K3s), Proxmox, VMware ESXi, Azure/Entra ID
Frameworks	NIST CSF 2.0, CIS Controls v8.1, NIST 800-53, ISO 27001, MITRE ATT&CK

PROJECTS

Operational Security Lab: Enterprise Monitoring & Detection Engineering | Jul 2025 – Present

Self-built, hardened lab simulating enterprise SOC operations — detection engineering, threat hunting, IR, and vulnerability management. pnleone.github.io/Career_Projects/projects/homelab

- Triaged and investigated alerts across dual SIEM platforms (Splunk + ELK) and Wazuh EDR; documented findings using formal IR procedures and TheHive case management
- Tuned Suricata IDS/IPS rules to reduce false positives and expand MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection coverage; integrated alerts into SOAR workflows (Shuffle, TheHive, Cortex, MISP)
- Deployed multi-vendor, segmented network architecture — pfSense HA cluster (CARP), OPNsense, FortiGate, and Palo Alto NGFW; centralized log aggregation across all zones
- Performed vulnerability assessments with OpenVAS and Nessus; tracked findings through full remediation cycle with documented outcomes
- Automated infrastructure provisioning with Terraform and Ansible; version-controlled IaC in GitHub; applied NIST CSF 2.0, CIS v8.1, and ISO 27001 controls

Threat Intelligence Brief: Ivanti VPN Exploitation – Detection Strategy & SOC Workflows | Oct 2025

Translated active threat campaign intelligence into actionable detection rules and SOC playbooks for a healthcare environment. pnleone.github.io/Career_Projects/projects/threat-intel

- Engineered YARA, Sigma, and Suricata rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK; integrated output into SIEM and SOAR-compatible playbooks
- Authored threat intelligence brief covering exploit chain correlation, FIM, and threat feed integration for healthcare SOC teams

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

NWN Carousel | Apr 2007 – Nov 2024

Progression: Systems Engineer → Senior Systems Engineer → Solution Architect (17 years)

Solution Architect (2014 – 2024)

- Translated complex enterprise requirements into scalable solution architectures across 100+ client environments spanning mid-market to Fortune 500 organizations
- Conducted in-depth technical discovery and needs analysis with enterprise stakeholders, aligning solutions to business objectives, risk tolerance, and compliance requirements
- Evaluated multi-vendor solutions across network, security, cloud, and collaboration domains; risk-based recommendations consistently drove 20–30% reductions in client operational costs
- Developed presales tooling and standardized proposal workflows that cut quoting cycle time by 30% and improved cross-team accuracy; delivered consistent 100%+ quota attainment

Senior Systems Engineer (2010 – 2014)

- Expanded technical scope to architect solutions across cloud platforms and collaboration technologies, supporting a broader enterprise client base
- Reduced engineering escalations by 25% through structured root-cause analysis and internal knowledge sharing
- Authored detailed technical proposals and solution designs that aligned vendor capabilities with enterprise requirements, influencing client procurement decisions

Systems Engineer (2007 – 2010)

- Designed and scoped unified communications solutions for enterprise clients; translated technical requirements into solution proposals and architecture documentation
- Supported the full presales cycle from technical discovery through proposal delivery; advised clients on complex migration and modernization projects

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.S. Management Information Systems | Binghamton University, SUNY

Cybersecurity Certificate | College of Staten Island, CUNY | *Apr – Oct 2025*

Certifications: CCNA (Jul 2024) | CompTIA Security+ (Feb 2025) | TryHackMe SOC Level 1 (Aug 2025) | TryHackMe Jr. Penetration Tester (Oct 2025)